

Hygiene and Care of the Patient's Environment

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Chapter 9: four ideas to connect

Personal and oral hygiene

Individualize care to promote comfort, prevent infection, and protect the mouth and skin.

Bathing and grooming

Support cleanliness and self-esteem while preserving privacy and safe independence.

Bed and environment

Maintain clean, dry linens and an organized setting that supports rest and skin protection.

Skin and dignity

Inspect skin during care, report changes, and encourage the patient to do what is safely possible.

Put the chapter into safe practical nursing care

Hygiene is care, assessment, comfort, and dignity at the same time.

Offer choices, protect privacy, and encourage safe participation. Observe the mouth, skin, mobility, pain, and tolerance during care, then report redness, breakdown, or other concerning changes.

- ✓ Explain and offer choices
- ✓ Protect privacy and warmth
- ✓ Encourage independence
- ✓ Observe mouth and skin
- ✓ Leave the environment safe

RECOGNIZE → ACT → REPORT

Protect dignity.
Observe the skin.
Leave a safe space.

Before moving on, explain the cue, your immediate action within scope, and the facts you would report.